

You need to find out what kind of people want to buy web hosting, what platform will be choosing, and in turn what CMS should you provide them.

3.1 IIS+.NET or LAMP?

Internet Information Server (IIS) is a web server application created by Microsoft and can operate on Windows NT, Windows XP, Windows 2000, Windows 7.

LAMP is an acronym that stands for Linux (operating system), Apache Server, MySQL (database software), and PHP. It is a bundle of software programs that provides a platform for developing and implementing web.

Before selling web hosting, you have to choose a platform. While your client base may include novice users who just want to start a business, you may also encounter companies that might want to buy hosting. You should also take your interests into consideration so that you leave no stone unturned while providing service to your customer.

In case you're confused or have no idea about any programming or scripting language, here are a few pros and cons you might want to consider before advising your client.

The first step is to buy web hosting keeping your customer in mind. Also find out which language they are comfortable with - PHP or ASP.NET? If your service provider offers you the option of using either of the two for a negligible difference in price, it's wise to opt for such a plan.

Nevertheless, in case there is a choice that you need to make, then the main advantage of using Linux hosting is that it's open source. Not that it makes much of a difference in normal operations; but the way things work out, your client stands a good chance of getting quick community help on any issue you may face with Linux hosting. Generally, reseller accounts with Linux hosting offer quick install options for content management systems such as WordPress, Drupal, Joomla and may be even phpBB or Wikis. PHP can run on Linux and other servers including Microsoft whereas ASP.NET can run only on Microsoft servers. It can run on other servers too but with less efficiency. PHP is very easy to get started with.

ASP.NET is a platform for deployment, execution and maintenance of applications for Windows. It is not an open source programming platform. You may charge your customer for it. Your client may also insist on using ASP.NET due to their familiarity with the language or their existing infrastructure of Microsoft servers.

Free tutorials of PHP are easily available on the web. On the other hand, finding ASP.NET help is quite an effort. Nevertheless, there are plenty of books and ebooks that you can purchase.